

Anshuman Magazine, Chairman & CEO for India, South-East Asia, Middle East & Africa, CBRE, which claims to be a leader in global commercial real estate services, has the break-up of the carbon generated by the construction industry.

The production of materials used in the construction industry accounts for 25-27% of the carbon emitted across the project lifecycle, construction accounts for 2-3%, operations 69-70% and demolition approximately 2-3%, says Magazine.

How does one get sustainable numbers? Use on-site renewables, retrofit, and go for end-of-life replacement, coupled with efficient equipment use. Together, these can reduce energy consumption by 35%, he says. Magazine further says green transportation strategies, green procurement strategies, use of recycled materials, advanced EV charging infrastructure, and circular economy initiatives will help reduce carbon emissions by 35%.

De of KPMG says we must reduce both embodied carbon and operational carbon while developing infrastructure. "Embodied carbon can be reduced by using low carbon materials in building the urban infrastructure and buildings. Operational carbon can be reduced through energy-efficient design and operations," says De.

The bottom line: the government should work out strong building codes that are implemented and enforced.

GREEN TRAVEL

To address emissions of the largely oil-dependent transportation sector, India has already implemented several policies and initiatives to promote the adoption of electric vehicles (EVs) and accelerate the transition to a cleaner transportation future. Jain of Primus Partners calls for more tax rebates and subsidies. "The government could intro-



"There is a need to incentivise the usage of renewable energy through subsidies and scale up policies supporting its adoption. A focus on energy efficiency programmes and the expansion of low-carbon technologies like green hydrogen will play a crucial role"

JOHN SLAVEN
CEO, VEDANTA ALUMINIUM



"At the Government of India level, a strong enabling environment has been built. There is still a challenge at the state level, which needs to be overcome"

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duce attractive incentives such as cash rebates and tax breaks for EV purchases, making them more affordable than traditional petrol or diesel vehicles," says Jain. The government could nudge vehicle owners to replace polluting vehicles with EVs by scrapping subsidies on the petrol/ diesel ones.

Then, says Jain, why not have innovative subscription models similar to the ones in mobile telephony to make EVs more accessible across various income levels? This will address the upfront cost barrier.

Incentives and regulatory frameworks are also required to encourage the electrification of commercial fleets, including taxis and buses, promoting a quicker transition in high-impact sectors. In agriculture, the focus is and should continue to be on reducing emissions without compromising food security and should address methane emissions from livestock and rice cultivation.

Other than focussing on the key emitting sectors and putting policies and incentives in place, India should also prioritise a diverse range of international collaborations and partnerships.

How? Go for international collaborations and partnerships across sectors, says Viral Thakker, Partner & Sustainability Leader at consultants Deloitte India.

Thakker reels off the list of sectors in which India could focus while looking for collaborations with top universities: Sustainable practices for climate resilient agriculture, renewable energy, battery storage and energy-efficient technologies, developing carbon markets, climate finance and green investment, etc.

International cooperation is essential for tackling the global climate crisis, and India's leadership in this domain can pave the way for a more sustainable future for all. **BT**

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